

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Mahajanapadas: long state-formation transition

JANA -> JANAPADA -> MAHAJANAPADA -> IMPERIAL THRESHOLD

kin community territorial base large competing states Magadhan/Mauryan platform

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c. 1000-600 BCE changes -> c. 6th-4th centuries BCE competitive state system

Sixteen is a conventional list; state formation was neither simultaneous nor linear.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Sixteen Mahajanapadas: political text map

NORTH-WEST: Gandhara, Kamboja | UPPER PLAIN: Kuru, Panchala, Matsya, Surasena

CENTRAL/WEST: Chedi, Avanti, Vatsa | TRANS-VINDHYAN: Assaka

MIDDLE/EAST GANGA: Kashi, Kosala, Anga, Magadha

REPUBLICAN EAST: Vajji, Malla | textual lists and placements can vary

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FOUR LEADING MONARCHIES: Magadha, Kosala, Vatsa, Avanti

Map polity to capital, route and rivalry; do not draw fixed modern borders.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Monarchy and gana-sangha compared

MONARCHY	GANA-SANGHA
hereditary/dynastic rajan	assembly of chiefly lineages
court, officials, organised force	deliberation among oligarchic elites
expanding taxation/territory	corporate sovereignty/confederacy
village heads link centre/local	non-elite, women and dependants excluded
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Two state forms: gana was not modern democracy; monarchy was not automatic progress.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Second urbanisation: city-system mechanism

agricultural surplus + extraction + crafts + routes + merchant finance

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Rajagriha | Kaushambi | Vaishali | Champa | later Pataliputra

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NBPW horizon + craft quarters + markets + punch-marked coin circulation

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Urbanisation was networked and uneven; NBPW and coins are indicators, not sole causes.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Agrarian political economy and social change

forest clearance/fields + iron in context + cattle/plough labour

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surplus -> tax/share -> army/officials/forts -> market and town demand

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gahapati household elites

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setthi, merchants and craft groups

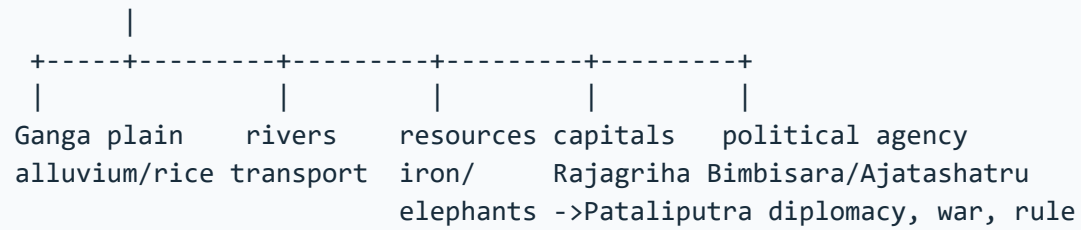
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Varna claims, new wealth and shramana critiques intersect in urbanising society.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Why Magadha? interacting causal matrix

MAGADHAN ASCENDANCY

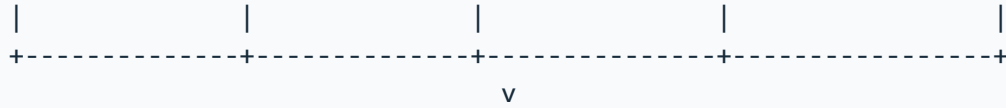


Advantages became power through institutions; no geography or resource monopoly alone.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Magadhan dynastic expansion sequence

BIMBISARA -> AJATASHATRU -> UDAYIN -> SHISHUNAGA -> NANDAS -> MAURYAN THRESHOLD

Anga, marriage Kosala/Vajji wars Pataliputra Avanti absorbed resources/army

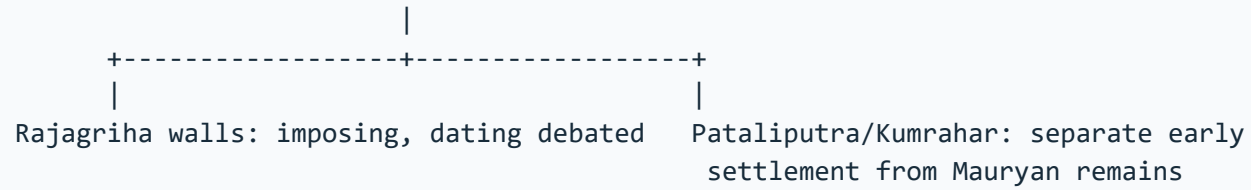


Expansion combined conquest, diplomacy, capital relocation and accumulation.

Traditions disagree on exact succession; use the sequence without false precision.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Archaeology and source limits of early Magadha

SOURCES: Buddhist/Jaina traditions + Puranic lists + archaeology + later reports



VERDICT: texts preserve political memory; archaeology tests place and phase, not episode.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: From competitive states to empire

MAHAJANAPADA COMPETITION

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larger armies + taxation + capitals + routes + diplomatic repertoires

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Magadhan absorption of Anga, Vajji, Kosala links and Avanti rivalry

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Nanda-scale accumulation -> institutional and territorial platform for Mauryas
Legacy is capacity-building, not destiny; rivals once had viable alternatives.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Mahajanapada-Magadha answer architecture

ANSWER SPINE

1. Define jana, janapada and mahajanapada with source-list caution.
2. Map polity -> capital -> river/route, then compare monarchy and gana.
3. Explain Magadha through factor -> evidence -> mechanism -> rival -> limit.

VERDICT: Magadhan supremacy was conjunctural, cumulative and contingent.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Evidence ladder and confidence control

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. Texts preserve lists, rulers and conflicts through layered traditions.
2. Archaeology dates settlements, NBPW and walls but rarely names rulers.
3. Coins show circulation and valuation, not one issuer or universal money use.

VERDICT: Correlate text, material and landscape evidence at matching scales.

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. Sixteen is a conventional list; republic means restricted clan oligarchy.
 2. NBPW is one urban marker; iron and rivers are enabling, not sufficient.
 3. Dynastic dates, Nanda origins and army figures remain tradition-dependent.
- VERDICT: Stop at the Mauryan threshold and reject inevitable single-factor rise.